

Chapter 171-4

Very quickly, the trending searches were dominated by Yang Shuyan and Zhao Ying.

The fans continued to fight.

Yang Shuyan and Zhao Ying both received calls from their managers one after another. Both gave the same response: "Just leave it."

Liang Shi turned around again and glanced at the trending searches.

Mm, online rumors really couldn't be trusted.

Liang Shi messaged Xu Qingzhu with a straight face: [The two of them are... showing off their love as if no one else exists.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Our Teacher Liang has it hard.]

Liang Shi: [Huh?]

Xu Qingzhu: [See no evil.]

Liang Shi: [Okay.]

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Meeting with the director and producer of "*Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*" didn't involve anything else significant. They just chatted casually and asked about Liang Shi's upcoming schedule.

Liang Shi mentioned that she had passed the audition for the second female lead in a historical costume drama, but the filming start date hadn't been set yet.

The director then asked if she would be interested in playing the female lead in *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*—the role that Shu Yi had previously been cast for.

Liang Shi didn't agree immediately, but she politely explained to the director that since she had now signed with an agency and had a manager, she naturally needed to go through her manager to negotiate. But if the timing worked out, she would definitely take the role.

After all, she really liked the script for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*.

Liang Shi had Chang Hui negotiate both dramas, and things went very smoothly.

Since all the arrangements for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* were already in place, they would film that one first. The other drama was still in the process of negotiating for the female lead—it hadn't been decided whether it would be Yang Shuyan or another competitor—so it would take some more time.

This happened to leave Liang Shi time to film *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*.

During this free period, the script for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* had also been revised, so what Liang Shi and Zhao Ying received was the corrected version. It differed somewhat from the original but had become better—especially the character Liang Shi would be playing, which was now more outstanding.

After Liang Shi took on this role, the role she had originally auditioned for became vacant. The director searched for a long time but couldn't find anyone more suitable, so Liang Shi recommended Tang Zui for the part.

Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo had been shelved for too long before. Once filming was confirmed again, all the processes moved quickly—recasting roles, taking costume fitting photos, holding the boot ceremony¹, and the production team officially announcing the cast.

The combination of Liang Shi and Zhao Ying also took everyone by surprise.

After all, Liang Shi was still a newcomer. None of her dramas had aired yet, and her movie hadn't been released either.

Even *Journey of the Heart* hadn't started its promotional announcements—that was just happening these few days.

As soon as the casting news for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* came out, it immediately stirred up a storm online.

[Am I seeing things? Has Zhao Ying fallen so low that she's working with an 18th-tier nobody?]

[Is this to have Zhao Ying boost the company's newcomer? I really don't understand.]

[@Zhao Ying, I thought things would be better after you switched companies. Turns out you're just going to another company to babysit newcomers?]

[This Liang Shi is definitely a resource mooch². I could understand if you replaced Shu Yi with Yang Shuyan, but replacing her with some unknown newcomer?]

[I heard this person also acted in Quella's new movie. Is she really a resource mooch?]

[Anyway, I'm disgusted. @Director, can you please put effort into writing the script and not use your feet to pick actors?]

[.....]

When the latest casting news for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* came out, compared to last time, Liang Shi was criticized much more severely.

Before, because Liang Shi was playing a supporting role, her red dress look had just gone viral, and there was the effect of putting down Chen Liuying, so online reception was overwhelmingly positive.

But now the original female lead Shu Yi had gotten into trouble. Even if she had moral and mental issues, her status and abilities were still there for all to see.

How could this "newcomer" Liang Shi directly take over her position?

There was obviously something wrong!

No other speculation beyond Liang Shi being a "resource mooch."

Liang Shi had no way to defend herself. She was so busy that she only glanced at the trending searches once and then stopped paying attention.

Her time was too tight.

Filming for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* began, and her scenes increased dramatically—not just the suddenly increased dialogue, but also some dances she had to learn from scratch.

Shu Yi had graduated from a dance academy. Things that had been simple for her were very difficult for Liang Shi.

But Liang Shi had a competitive personality in this regard. Since she had taken on this drama, she would do it well. So she firmly refused to use a body double.

She hired a dance teacher to teach her. She filmed during the day and practiced dancing at night.

Even under this high-pressure environment, she still insisted on going home.

However, *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* was a modern drama. Except for the initial location shots, the rest was all filmed within the city, fairly close to her home—about a half-hour drive.

Xu Qingzhu had told her she didn't need to come back and could just stay at a hotel, but Liang Shi always insisted.

Liang Shi felt that while pursuing dreams was important, family was also important.

She didn't want Xu Qingzhu to be alone at home while pregnant.

Pregnant people were prone to overthinking, and Xu Qingzhu was already a bit sensitive when it came to their relationship. Liang Shi could only do her best to put Xu Qingzhu's mind at ease.

Moreover, after going home, Xu Qingzhu could practice lines with her. Even just casually chatting made Liang Shi feel relaxed.

Even if her body was exhausted, Liang Shi's heart was still at ease.

She didn't feel tired at all.

Acting with Zhao Ying was a very comfortable experience. Liang Shi's acting hadn't reached perfection, but it was quite good for a modern urban drama. Especially since this character was somewhat similar to herself, she played it with ease.

Many scenes were done in single takes, and her scenes with Zhao Ying almost always passed in one go.

In this busy environment, Liang Shi spent about half a month.

During her filming period, *"Let's Go, Right Now"* aired.

Although it was a small variety show, it bought several trending searches on the day it aired.

Most critically, there was the previously unknown Liang Xinran.

Someone with no works suddenly appearing on a variety show alongside some quite famous people raised expectations.

At the same time, some people recognized that Liang Xinran was the person who had been searching for family online before.

The national recognition and goodwill she had accumulated before came in handy now. Everyone rushed to boost her popularity.

Liang Xinran also posted a promotional Weibo.

@Liang Xinran: This is my first time participating in a variety show. I was worried that showing my clumsy self on the big screen would disappoint everyone, but I still mustered up the courage to do it~ I hope everyone won't mind. #Let's Go, Right Now#

At the same time, a small brand under Dongheng—which was also the title sponsor of *"Let's Go, Right Now"*—announced their spokesperson on the same day: Liang Xinran.

Although her situation was somewhat similar to Liang Shi's before, public reception was completely different.

[Didn't someone say before that the family this young lady found was wealthy? Looks like it's confirmed now?]

[What is this wealthy heiress lost and found Mary Sue³ plotline!]

[As everyone knows, this young lady's surname used to be Guo, and she had a hard life. Now she's changed back to her birth family's surname. And the CEO of Dongheng Group's surname is Liang, and this brand is controlled by Dongheng. Think about it. Think carefully.]

[Isn't this just a wealthy heiress coming to play in the entertainment industry? Thank you, miss, for lowering yourself to our level.]

[Does jiejie⁴ still want a wife? I volunteer!]

[.....]

Online, it was almost entirely praise.

Liang Xinran's personal popularity exceeded the show's popularity.

Footnotes:

¹ **Boot ceremony (開機儀式):** A traditional ceremony held at the start of filming a Chinese drama or movie, similar to a "first day of shooting" celebration. It often includes burning incense, prayers for smooth filming, and photo opportunities with the cast and crew.

² **Resource mooch (資源咖):** Chinese entertainment industry slang for someone who gets roles and opportunities not through talent but through connections, money, or powerful backers. It implies they're taking resources that should go to more deserving people.

³ **Mary Sue (瑪麗蘇):** A term for an idealized, often unrealistic female character or storyline, typically featuring a perfect protagonist. Here it refers to the "lost princess reunited with wealthy family" trope common in romance novels.

⁴ **Jiejie (姐姐):** Literally "older sister," but commonly used online as an affectionate term for admired female celebrities, regardless of actual age relationship.